

raphy gone wrong – not due to the nature of its use but due to its failure to remain a secret language.

Who uses Cryptography?

You. Yes, you do use cryptography. How? Answer the following questions:

1. Do you use Facebook?
2. Do you use Gmail?
3. Have you ever opened a PDF or ZIP file that asked you a password?
4. Did you ever use an *HTTPS* site?
5. Do you chat with your friends on the internet?
6. Do you fill forms on the internet?

If the answer to all the questions is ‘no’, then maybe you don’t use cryptography. Our guess is there’s a very rare chance that you answered with a ‘no’ to all the questions. Cryptography is everywhere and we use it daily. It doesn’t only involve using arcane commands on a black terminal. It’s present in the day-to-day tools we use – zipping software, PDF viewers, word processors, browsers and what not. People who don’t use computers also use cryptography.

Day-to-day tricks we use

You’ve probably heard of celebrities changing contact names in their phone books to avoid having to admit to infidelity. You must have done it too but for more worthy reasons such as for keeping a relationship under

wraps by changing your boyfriend’s contact name in your address book to ‘Vampire’ just because he is as loving to you as Edward was to Bella, then you have used cryptography. You may however need to get a life but that apart, changing your sweetheart’s name to one belonging to the opposite sex is nothing but cryptography.



Twitter over HTTPS. Most web browsers allow you to see the cryptographic information of a secure page by clicking the favicon on the address bar

What is not Cryptography?

Let’s say you skipped work for a day to party with some friends. You